Admission Criteria to critical care for Covid patients-Ysbyty Gwynedd

PPE guidelines must be adhered to when seeing and admitting these patients.

It is understood that all Covid level 2 patients with only respiratory problems will be looked after in the Covid cohort areas of the hospital and will be looked after by the respiratory physicians.

All level 2 Covid respiratory patients on >60% O2 or a PF ratio of less than 27 will be discussed by consultant looking after the Covid patients to consultant anaesthetics/ITU as soon as possible. There will be two meetings per day between these groups ie the consultant for ITU and the Covid consultant, one in the morning and one in the evening. All the at-risk patients will be discussed and an escalation plan discussed. The discussion will determine if the patient needs immediate step up to level 3 or a wait and see approach is needed. The discussion must also determine whether level 3 will benefit the patient. Ceilings of care may need to be implemented and level 3 care declined for those who are deemed unlikely to benefit ie those with significant morbidities and high frailty scores.

Only patients needing intubation will be admitted to critical care with the caveat below.

Some patients may need critical care for other reasons but happen to be infected with Covid, but is not in respiratory failure, for example inotropic support, post operative care or CVVHD for acute renal failure. These patients must be isolated in a cubicle on critical care as they are a high risk of spreading Covid to staff and other patients. They are not to go to Enlli (level 2) ward as this is a non-Covid area.

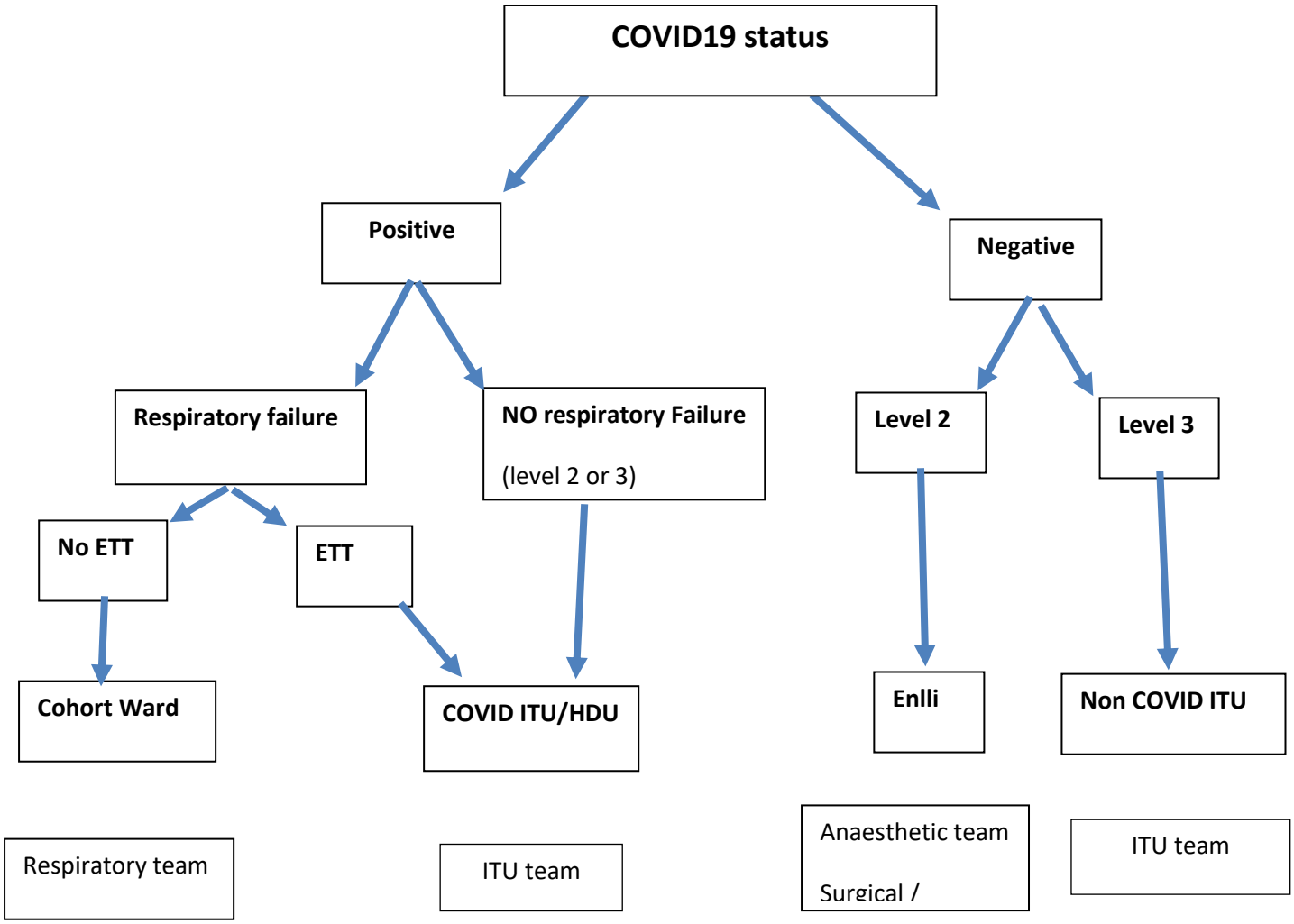
Patients will be discharged to Enlli once they have been extubated if they need level 2 care as by this time they will be Covid negative if they need level 2 care. Otherwise they will be discharged to the respiratory ward, or the Covid area if they are still Covid positive, under the care of the respiratory physicians.

Definitions;

Level 2-One organ failure or requiring >60% O2

Level 3-2 Organ failure or respiratory failure requiring intubation.

ITU referral and Admission Decision Process



EFH 18/03/20